agreements paved the way for greater integration between India and Bangladesh, including road, rail, and electric grids. Issues of migration and border deaths, which had long dominated bilateral relations, also became easier to address. In the years that followed, Bangladesh became the largest recipient of Indian state-backed lending, often for infrastructure projects such as railways and power plants.

New Delhi's ties with Afghanistan also saw an upswing during this period. President Ashraf Ghani had begun his tenure by trying to broker an agreement with Pakistan and distancing himself from India. The breakdown of that arrangement led to a warmer relationship with New Delhi, including a Trilateral Transport Agreement involving India, Iran, and Afghanistan; an India–Afghanistan air freight corridor; and the conclusion of a number of major infrastructure projects, such as the Salma Dam which was renamed the Afghan–India Friendship Dam. [15]

Relations proved more challenging with Nepal, Sri Lanka, and the Maldives. With Nepal, Modi's successful visit and India's speedy delivery of relief assistance following a devastating 2015 earthquake were offset by political developments in Kathmandu. The promulgation of a new Constitution in Nepal was perceived by ethnic Madhesis to be discriminatory. The subsequent agitations along the India–Nepal border led to closures of commercial traffic, for which Nepal's leaders blamed India. Eventually, despite only marginal constitutional changes, the blockade ended, but the episode left some lasting bad blood between Kathmandu and New Delhi. Concerns about China's growing political and economic influence in Nepal contributed to differences, as did the resurrection by Nepal of smaller territorial disputes. It would take some years before India could restore positive relations with most major political stakeholders in Kathmandu and offer greater economic opportunities—particularly in purchases of hydroelectric energy—to Nepal. [16]

Sri Lanka also saw swings in relations with India tied to domestic politics and Colombo's relations with China. Under Mahinda Rajapaksa, Sri Lanka took on major loans for infrastructure development in and around Hambantota, including a port and an airport. The non-commercial nature of